

CONTACT INFORMATION

John Munro Godfrey, Sr. Department of Economics
Terry College of Business
University of Georgia
Athens, GA 30602-6254

henry.downes@uga.edu
+1 (860) 305-5327
henrymdownes.com

EMPLOYMENT AND AFFILIATIONS

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Georgia	2025-
Faculty Affiliate, Wilson Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities (LEO)	2025-
Special Sworn Status, U.S. Census Bureau	2023-

EDUCATION

University of Notre Dame – Notre Dame, IN	
Ph.D. in Economics	2025
M.A. in Economics	2020
 University of Alabama – Tuscaloosa, AL	
B.A. in Economics, Political Science, and History, <i>summa cum laude</i>	2015
Visiting Student at Universität Mannheim	2013

PUBLICATIONS

Downes, H., Phillips, D. C. and Sullivan, J. X. (2022), ‘The Effect of Emergency Financial Assistance on Healthcare Use’, *Journal of Public Economics* **208**, 104626. [[Published Version](#)]

WORKING PAPERS

‘Did Organized Labor Induce Labor? Unionization and the American Baby Boom’ (Job Market Paper) [[PDF](#)]
‘The Low-Income Housing Tax Credit and Economic Opportunity’ (with Stephanie Karol, John Soriano, and George Zuo) [[PDF](#)]
‘How Risk Attitudes and Homeowners Insurance Literacy Impact Shopping and Switching Behaviors’ (with Sebastain Awondo)

WORK IN PROGRESS

‘Source of Income Laws and Racial Discrimination in Rental Markets’
‘The Low-Income Housing Tax Credit and Tenant Financial Well-Being’ (with John Soriano and George Zuo)
‘The Long-Run Effects of Intensive Services for Homeless Individuals: Experimental Evidence from Atlanta’
‘Unions, Employer-Sponsored Health Insurance, and the Rise of the Healthcare Economy’ (with Mateus Dias, Frank Keat, and Edson Severnini)
‘Union Membership and Wage Theft’

TEACHING

University of Georgia

Instructor	Labor Economics (UG)	2025-
------------	----------------------	-------

University of Notre Dame

Instructor	Principles of Microeconomics (UG)	2023
Instructor	Moreau College Initiative (UG)	2023
TA	Statistics for Economists (UG)	2022-2023
Tutor	Econometrics (UG)	2022
Tutor	Statistics for Economists (UG)	2021

EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS

2026: LERA @ ASSAs; FSU-UF-UGA Critical Issues in Real Estate Symposium; Georgia State University

2025: University of Georgia; University of California, Davis; Florida State University; University of Florida; Ohio State University; Texas A&M University; College of William & Mary; Tilburg University; University of Alabama; North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association

2024: Mountain West Economic History Conference; Northwestern University; NBER Summer Institute; Economic History Association; Miami University; Southern Economic Association

2023: Midwest Economic Association (session organizer, chair, and presenter); World Congress of Cliometrics; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management

2022: Young Economist Symposium; Social Science History Association

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

External

Economic History Association, Graduate Dissertation Fellowship (\$10,000)	2024-2025
---	-----------

Smith Richardson Foundation, Domestic Public Policy Program (\$268,091)	2023-2025
---	-----------

University of Notre Dame

Eli J. and Helen Shaheen Graduate School Award in Social Sciences	2025
---	------

Graduate School, Three Minute Thesis (3MT) Competition Winner	2024
---	------

Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award	2024
---	------

Graduate Student Government, Conference Presentation Grant	2024
--	------

Institute for Ethics and the Common Good, Graduate Fellowship	2023-2024
---	-----------

Center for Social Concerns, Graduate Fellowship	2022-2023
---	-----------

Institute for Scholarship in the Liberal Arts, Graduate Research Grant	2022
--	------

Graduate School, Professional Development Grant	2021
---	------

University of Alabama

College of Arts & Sciences, Most Outstanding Junior	2014
---	------

Department of Economics, Special Achievement Award	2014
--	------

SERVICE

University of Notre Dame

Organizer, Graduate Student Research Workshop	2021-2022
---	-----------

Co-Chair, Economics Department Graduate Student Council	2021-2022
---	-----------

Ambassador, Economics Department	2019-2025
----------------------------------	-----------

ACADEMIC REFEREEING

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Journal of Economic History, Southern Economic Journal

PERSONAL

Citizenship: U.S.A.